THE COLD BREW CREW

Brew the Perfect Cold Brew at Home

Learner Handout · The Cold Brew Crew

QUICK FORMULA

The recipe in one line: 1 part coarse coffee to 4 parts water, steep, filter twice, dilute 1:1 with water or milk.

Course at a Glance

MODULE	YOU WILL LEARN TO…	TIME
1. Gear, Beans & Ratios on a Budget	Pick your gear, your grind and your ratio	~5 min
2. Steeping & Filtration	Steep for the right time and filter twice	~5 min (with the lesson video)
3. Diluting, Storing & Troubleshooting	Turn your concentrate into a drink, keep it fresh, fix your next batch	~5 min

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MODULE 01

Module 1 · Gear, Beans & Ratios on a Budget

Objective: identify the gear you need, the right grind size and a baseline coffee-to-water ratio.

1. Minimal gear (under €20 extra)

You probably own most of this already. Even if you buy everything, it stays under €20.

- A large glass jar (1–2 L) or a pitcher
- A fine-mesh sieve
- Paper coffee filters or a clean cotton cloth
- A basic kitchen scale
- Optional: a French press can replace the jar and the sieve

2. Choose and grind your beans

- Grind: extra-coarse, like coarse sea salt. Fine grounds over-extract and give a muddy, bitter cold brew.
- Pre-ground coffee: choose one labelled for French press or coarse brewing.
- Roast: many people like medium to dark roasts for cold brew; light roasts taste brighter and fruitier. Try what you like.

3. The baseline ratio: 1:4

Cold brew is made as a concentrate that you dilute later (Module 3).

- Ratio: 1 part coffee to 4 parts water, by weight.
- Example: 100 g of coarse coffee + 400 g (400 ml) of water.
- Weigh, don't scoop: a cup of coffee grounds weighs more or less depending on the grind.



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MODULE 02

Module 2 · Steeping & Filtration

Objective: select the right steeping time and filtering method for a batch.

1. Combine and steep

1. Put the coarse grounds in the jar and pour the water over them.
2. Stir gently until all the grounds are wet.
3. Cover the jar with a lid or a small plate.
4. Steep: 12–16 hours at room temperature, or 18–24 hours in the fridge. Never more than 24 hours.

Why the difference? Cold slows extraction, so fridge brewing takes longer.

2. Filter twice

1. First pass: pour through the fine-mesh sieve to catch the big grounds.
2. Second pass: line the sieve with a paper filter or a clean cloth and pour again, slowly.

Tip: let it drain on its own rather than squeezing the cloth, which can push fine particles into your coffee.

Watch the lesson video (1 min 44) on the course page to see every step.



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Module 3 · Diluting, Storing & Troubleshooting

Objective: brew a first batch of ready-to-drink cold brew using the course's ratio, dilution and storage guidelines.

1. Dilute

1. Pour some concentrate into a glass with ice.
2. Add the same amount of water or milk (1:1).
3. Taste. Too strong? Go up to 1:2.

2. Store

- Concentrate: in a sealed glass jar in the fridge. Best within a week, up to 2 weeks.
- Diluted cold brew: drink it within 2–3 days.
- Write the brew date on the jar.

3. Fix your next batch

YOUR COLD BREW IS…	TRY THIS NEXT TIME
Too bitter	A coarser grind or a shorter steep
Too weak	More coffee or a longer steep
Sour	A longer steep
Flat, stale	A fully sealed jar with little air inside

4. Self-check: my first batch

- [ ] I used a 1:4 ratio, weighed on a scale
- [ ] I noted the steep time and where it steeped (counter or fridge)
- [ ] I filtered twice
- [ ] I diluted 1:1 and adjusted to taste
- [ ] My verdict: too bitter / too weak / sour / just right
- [ ] The brew date is on the jar



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